

Nowe Horyzonty — Friday, July 25, 2026

Your movie menu · morning block skipped · one pick per block · 53 films across 4 blocks

Block 1 — Early Afternoon starts 12:15-13:45

Fukushima z Bélą Tarrem, Osądzanie na Węgrzech, Włosy, papier, woda..., Allegro Pastell, Gruber nas opuszcza, Karuzela, Nie ma duchów w mieszkaniu na Dobrej, Shortlista zestaw 1, Natura miłości, Fantazja, Zmartwychwstanie, Vincent. Legenda oceanu, Shana

Block 2 — Late Afternoon starts 15:45-16:30

Pewnego razu w Harlemie, Żółte listy, Kamienie szlachetne, Performer, Flesh and Fuel, Wieczny płomień, Smuga cieni, Dziennik dla moich dzieci, Dziennik panny służącej, Dni, których nie znamy, Modlitwa za umierających, Chronovisor

Block 3 — Evening starts 18:45-19:15

Dryfy, Ktoś we mnie, Piękny i schludny pokój, Nienormalni, Śmierć nie ma pana, Najsamotniejszy człowiek w mieście, Białe ślimaki, Clarissa, Gość, Arru, Powiedz mi, co czujesz, Wolfgang, Jeśli się przewrócę, nie podnoś mnie

Block 4 — Night starts 21:30-22:30

Wartość sentymentalna, Nad rzeką, której nie ma, The Meltdown, Czarna kula, Krwawa Hrabina, Ogród, Lewitując, Noc się dłuży, Filipińska, Czysta krew, Romería, Gorgona, Jaripeo, Sirât, Leviticus

Block 1 — Early Afternoon

12:15-13:45 starts · choose ONE film from this block

POKAZY SPECJALNE

Fukushima z Bélą Tarrem

Fukushima with Béla Tarr

12:15-15:15 · KNH 8 · Kaori Oda · Japonia, 2024 · 180 min

A three-hour documentary following legendary Hungarian director Béla Tarr as he runs a filmmaking workshop with students in Fukushima, Japan.

Directed by Kaori Oda, one of Tarr's first students at his Film Factory school in Sarajevo, this documentary portrait observes Tarr teaching and mentoring young filmmakers on location in disaster-affected Fukushima. It follows the process of developing student film projects, showing Tarr's approach to storytelling, location scouting, and building tension in scenes. Oda's earlier films (*Aragane*, *Toward a Common Tenderness*, *Cenote*) premiered at Rotterdam and DOK Leipzig, and she won the 2020 Nagisa Oshima Award. Runtime is a full 180 minutes (3 hours).

INSTYTUCJE / STRUKTURY / WSPÓLNOTY

Osądzanie na Węgrzech

Judgment in Hungary

12:30-14:18 · KNH 4 · Eszter Hajdú · Węgry, Niemcy, Portugalia, 2013 · 108 min · Q&A after screening

An observational documentary covering the 167-day trial of Hungarian right-wing extremists accused of murdering Roma people in 2008-2009.

Director Eszter Hajdú's crew filmed the entire courtroom process of a case in which six Roma people were killed and four suspects stood trial. The film scrutinizes the prejudices voiced by witnesses, lawyers, and a notably severe judge, raising the question of who is really on trial - the murderers or their victims. It won 19 international awards and screened in over 40 countries. Runtime 108 minutes; a Q&A follows the screening.

MIĘDZYNARODOWY KONKURS NOWE HORYZONTY

Włosy, papier, woda...

Hair, Paper, Water...

12:45–13:56 · KNH 7 · Nicolas Graux, Minh Quý Truong · Francja, Belgia, Wietnam, 2025 · 71 min

A 16mm documentary essay about Cao Thị Hậu, one of the last members of Vietnam's Rục ethnic minority, preserving her people's language and stories for her grandson.

Shot on grainy Bolex 16mm film by directors Nicolas Graux and Minh Quý Truong, the film follows an isolated Vietnamese minority community forced to abandon its traditional way of life after first contact with the outside world in the 1960s. Water and impermanence run through the film as visual metaphors for the erosion of collective memory. It centers on grandparenting and caregiving as ways cultural knowledge survives. The film won the Golden Leopard (Filmmakers of the Present) at Locarno 2025 and the Main Prize at BAFICI 2026.

TRZECIE OKO: KLUB ZŁAMANYCH SERC

Allegro Pastell

12:45–14:25 · KNH 2 · Anna Roller · Niemcy, 2026 · 100 min • Q&A after screening

A German drama about a long-distance millennial couple - a writer and a web designer - who keep pulling toward and away from each other between Berlin and a small town near Frankfurt.

Adapted by director Anna Roller from Leif Randt's novel (Randt also wrote the screenplay), the film follows Tanja and Jerome as their relationship plays out through long messages, train journeys, and visits. When Tanja panics about commitment around her 34th birthday, a website Jerome designed becomes a metaphor for the routines threatening their relationship. It's shot with a deliberately controlled color palette to mirror the characters' moods. The film follows Roller's earlier *Dead Girls Dancing* (shown at this festival in 2023) and contains strobe lighting. A Q&A follows the screening.

RETROSPEKTYWA: MARIE KREUTZER

Gruber nas opuszcza

Gruber Is Leaving

12:45–14:30 · DCF Lwów · Marie Kreutzer · Austria, 2015 · 105 min

An Austrian tragicomedy about a cold, work-obsessed Viennese businessman forced to confront mortality and reconsider his life after a serious diagnosis.

Directed by Marie Kreutzer (her second feature) and adapted from Doris Knecht's novel, the film follows Johannes Gruber, a narcissistic corporate executive estranged from his family, who meets DJ Sara on a business trip in Switzerland and feels an unexpected connection. Shortly after, he's diagnosed with a serious illness that pushes him to search for meaning. The film mixes drama with romantic comedy. It won Best Cinematography at Austria's Romy awards and Best Music at the Beijing International Film Festival, both in 2015. Part of the festival's Marie Kreutzer retrospective.

POKAZY GALOWE

Karuzela

Carousel

13:00–14:45 · KNH 1 · Rachel Lambert · USA, 2026 · 105 min

A US drama in which Chris Pine plays a divorced doctor in Cleveland who reconnects with his high school sweetheart, played by Jenny Slate, now returned to town.

Director Rachel Lambert, filming in her own hometown, follows Noah, who runs his late father's medical practice and cares for his anxious daughter, as his path crosses again with Rebecca. Both have changed since their teenage years, and a pivotal confrontation forces them to reckon with old emotional patterns and mutual shortcomings. The film centers on second chances and whether love is worth the complications it brings. Supporting cast includes Abby Ryder Fortson, Sam Waterston, and Katey Sagal.

SMART 7

Nie ma duchów w mieszkaniu na Dobrej

No Ghosts on Good Street

13:00–14:30 · DCF Lalka · Emi Buchwald · Polska, 2025 · 90 min · Q&A after screening

A Polish debut feature about four neurotic adult siblings who have an unspoken pact to look after each other, until one of them breaks it.

Director Emi Buchwald's debut feature follows Jana, Franek, Nastka, and Benek, whose mutual dependence is upended when one sibling challenges their long-standing arrangement, forcing all four to renegotiate their relationships. The film has a loose, episodic structure and naturalistic dialogue, drawing comparisons to J.D. Salinger. It won Best Director at the 2025 Gdynia Festival of Polish Feature Films along with several other awards, including the Złoty Pazur (Andrzej Żuławski Award). A Q&A follows the screening.

SHORTLISTA

Shortlista zestaw 1

Shortlist Set 1

13:00–14:11 · KNH 5 · , · 71 min · Q&A after screening

A programme of six new Polish short films from the festival's Shortlista selection, running about 71 minutes total.

This block screens six recent Polish short films together: "Długa przerwa" (dir. Jan Sacek), about a teacher whose accidentally-sent intimate photos spiral into a scandal; "Lato gładkiego asfaltu" (dir. Maria Dakszewicz); "Niech zostanie bez tytułu" (dir. Mieszko Chomka); "Skrawki" (dir. Olga Papacz); "Spiritus sanctus" (dir. Michał Toczek); and "Trakcje" (dir. Jakub Krzyszpín). "Długa przerwa" won the Narrative Student Short award at Austin Film Festival 2025 and the Manifest Award at Poitiers Film Festival 2025. A Q&A follows the screening.

POKAZY GALOWE

Natura miłości

The Beloved

13:15–15:30 · KNH 9 · Rodrigo Sorogoyen · Hiszpania, Francja, 2026 · 135 min

A Spanish drama in which Javier Bardem plays a renowned, controversial filmmaker who casts his estranged daughter in the lead role of his new desert film project.

Directed by Rodrigo Sorogoyen, the film follows Esteban Martínez as he returns to Spain after years working in America to shoot an ambitious film in the desert, casting his daughter Emilía (a supporting actress) in a role that draws criticism from the industry and doubt from Emilía herself. Under the pressure of the shoot and the desert heat, old resentments and guilt resurface between father and daughter. Sorogoyen previously won multiple Goya Awards for Best Director and Screenplay for *The Kingdom and Beasts*. Cast includes Victoria Luengo, Raúl Arévalo, and Marina Foïs.

TRZECIE OKO: KLUB ZŁAMANYCH SERC

Fantazja

Fantasy

13:15–14:34 · KNH 3 · Isabel Pagliai · Francja, 2025 · 79 min

A French drama about a young woman, Louise, whose grief and vivid imagination blur the line between a real romance and one she may be inventing.

Director Isabel Pagliai's film follows Louise as she writes, walks, and grieves the disappearance of a man named Anton, uncertain whether he will return or ever existed. When a man named Thomas appears and their relationship develops entirely in forest settings, the film keeps it ambiguous whether he is real or a projection of her longing for connection. It's a coming-of-age story about loneliness and imagination as both refuge and a way of experiencing love, more driven by mood and emotion than conventional plot. The film won Best Debut at FIDMarseille 2025.

SEZON

Zmartwychwstanie

Resurrection

13:15–15:54 · DCF Polonia · Bi Gan · Chiny, Francja, USA, 2025 · 159 min

A Chinese sci-fi epic by Bi Gan set in a future where humanity has eliminated dreaming (and mortality), except for a cursed few "Phantoms" who still dream and experience cinema.

Structured as five interlinked segments spanning different film styles and eras - expressionist silent film, wartime noir, a Buddhist parable, a neorealist heist, and a millennial vampire romance - the film is both a genre tour and a formal tribute to cinema history itself. It won the Special Jury Prize at Cannes 2025. Cast includes Jackson Yee, Shu Qi, and Mark Chao. At 159 minutes, it's one of the longer films in this time block.

MŁODE HORYZONTY

Vincent. Legenda oceanu

The Last Whale Singer

13:15–14:46 · KNH 6 · Reza Memari · Niemcy, Czechy, Kanada, 2025 · 91 min

A German animated family film (age 6+) about a young humpback whale who sets off to rescue his parents and stop a monster called Leviathan from destroying the ocean.

After losing his parents - his father was the legendary "Whale Singer" whose song protected the sea - Vincent discovers the dangerous creature Leviathan has escaped from melting ice and now threatens the underwater world. Accompanied by an overprotective remora fish named Walter and a brave orca named Darya, he journeys to the mystical Sea of Eternity to bring his parents back. The film touches on loss, self-belief, teamwork, and environmental protection. Directed by Reza Memari; part of the festival's Młode Horyzonty (Young Horizons) children's section.

TRZECIE OKO: KLUB ZŁAMANYCH SERC

Shana

13:45–15:08 · DCF W-wa · Lila Pinell · Francja, 2026 · 83 min

A French semi-documentary-style drama following Shana, a chronically late, high-energy young woman navigating family conflict and a toxic ex through the Paris suburbs.

Director Lila Pinell shoots on 16mm with a loose, restless camera that follows Shana from one predicament to the next, using nervous editing to convey her mood swings and inner turbulence. Supported by close friends, Shana resists others' attempts to fix or judge her as she pushes back against family conflict and a toxic ex-boyfriend. The film treats its protagonist with compassion rather than moralizing. It won the SACD Prize at Cannes 2026 (Quinzaine des cinéastes); contains strobe lighting effects.

Block 2 — Late Afternoon

15:45–16:30 starts · choose ONE film from this block

MIĘDZYNARODOWY KONKURS NOWE HORYZONTY

Pewnego razu w Harlemie

Once Upon a Time in Harlem

15:45–17:25 · KNH 7 · William Greaves, David Greaves · USA, 2026 · 100 min

Documentary revisiting a 1972 gathering of Harlem Renaissance-era writers, musicians and activists at Duke Ellington's home, filmed by William Greaves and completed decades later by his son.

In 1972, filmmaker William Greaves filmed a one-off reunion of prominent Harlem Renaissance figures - writers, musicians, actors and activists - at the home of Duke Ellington. The footage sat unfinished until his son David Greaves, who operated a camera at the original event, completed the film a decade after his father's death. It documents hours of conversation and reflection among people who helped make Harlem a center of Black American culture. The film works as both a historical archive and a portrait of a vanished era.

POKAZY GALOWE

Żółte listy

Yellow Letters

15:45–17:53 · KNH 1 · İlker Çatak · Niemcy, Francja, Turcja, 2026 · 128 min

Turkish-language drama about a married couple of artists in Ankara whose careers and marriage collapse after an incident at a theatre premiere triggers state blacklisting.

Actress Derya and dramaturgy professor Aziz are respected artists in Ankara until an incident at a play's premiere provokes state reprisals, costing them their jobs, income and home and forcing a move to Istanbul. As they slide into poverty, Aziz holds onto his principles while Derya turns pragmatic, straining their marriage. Directed by İlker Çatak (*The Teachers' Lounge*), the film draws on real Turkish practices of blacklisting government critics. It won the Golden Bear for Best Film at Berlinale 2026. Runtime 128 minutes.

TROPIKALNY GOTYK

Kamienie szlachetne

Gemstones

15:45–16:55 · DCF Lwów · Simón Vélez · Kolumbia, Portugalia, 2026 · 70 min

Colombian crime drama about a young immigrant vineyard worker sent to steal an emerald from a church near Medellín, which drifts away from a straight heist plot into loose, sensory filmmaking.

Machado, a young Colombian working in French vineyards, is assigned to steal a valuable emerald from a church near Medellín. What starts as a heist setup loosens into an impressionistic, drifting film more interested in tropical landscapes, color and movement than plot mechanics. It is the feature debut of director Simón Vélez, based partly on events from the lead actor's own life, and premiered in Berlinale's Forum section. Spanish/French dialogue, 70 minutes.

RETROSPEKTYWA: ŁUKASZ RONDUDA

Performer

15:45–16:47 · KNH 4 · Łukasz Ronduda, Maciej Sobieszczęński · Polska, 2015 · 62 min • Q&A after screening

Polish mockumentary-style fiction film reimagining the life of conceptual artist Oskar Dawicki as a plotted "artist biography," using performance art in place of painting.

A hybrid fiction/documentary following artist Oskar Dawicki through a constructed storyline populated by art-world stock characters - the romantic artist, the collector, the gallerist, a rival colleague. Directors Łukasz Ronduda and Maciej Sobieszczęński treat performance art, rather than painting, as Dawicki's medium, structuring the film like a gallery exhibition told as a plot. It won the THINK:FILM Award at Berlinale 2015. English subtitles; the festival notes content warnings for sensitive material. 62 minutes, Poland, 2015.

ODKRYCIA

Flesh and Fuel

16:00–17:30 · KNH 8 · Pierre Le Gall · Francja, Polska, 2026 · 90 min • Q&A after screening

French-Polish drama about two long-haul truck drivers, Étienne and Bartosz, who fall for each other and try to sustain a relationship across borders and shifts.

Étienne is a French truck driver whose life is warehouses, border crossings and rest stops; his routine changes when he meets Polish driver Bartosz, whose optimism contrasts with his own resignation. As working conditions worsen, the two struggle to keep their relationship going in stolen moments between jobs. It is director Pierre Le Gall's feature debut, presented at Cannes Critics' Week 2026. Romance/drama, 90 minutes, France/Poland co-production.

SMART 7

Wieczny płomień

Eternal Flame

16:00–17:11 · DCF Lalka · Pedro Ramalhete · Portugalia, 2025 · 71 min

Portuguese comedy-drama about a Lisbon film-industry underdog - an unemployed screenwriter and a junior production assistant - navigating precarious jobs and a possible romance.

João, an out-of-work screenwriter, and Clary, a junior production assistant, navigate Lisbon's film industry, marked by low pay, few prospects and burnt-out colleagues. The film is both an insider satire of industry frustration and a romantic, cinephile-minded story about chance encounters and film love. It is director Pedro Ramalhete's feature debut. Comedy-drama, 71 minutes, Portugal, 2025.

LOST LOST LOST

Smuga cieni

Train of Shadows

16:00–17:33 · KNH 5 · José Luis Guerín · Hiszpania, 1997 · 93 min

Spanish experimental essay film in which a filmmaker restores lost reels shot by an obscure amateur director who died mysteriously decades earlier, told entirely without dialogue.

An unnamed filmmaker restores rediscovered footage shot by Gérard Fleury, an amateur director who died under mysterious circumstances decades before. Rather than solving the mystery, José Luis Guerín's 1997 film foregrounds visual texture, composition and the unreliability of memory, blurring documentary and fiction with no dialogue at all. It won prizes at the Sitges and Fantasporto festivals in 1997. Note: this screening pairs the feature with the short film "Płomień" (Flame, 2018) by Sami van Ingen.

RETROSPEKTYWA: MÁRTA MÉSZÁROS

Dziennik dla moich dzieci

Diary for My Children

16:00–17:47 · KNH 2 · Márta Mészáros · Węgry, 1984 · 107 min

Hungarian autobiographical drama, first part of Márta Mészáros's trilogy, about a teenage girl returning from the USSR in 1946 to be raised by a state security officer after her parents were killed under Stalin.

In 1946, teenage Juli returns to Hungary from the Soviet Union; both her parents died during Stalin's purges. She is adopted by a family friend who now works as a Hungarian state security officer, who gives her material comfort but faces Juli's resentment and rebellion, including skipping school to go to the cinema. The film is the first installment of director Márta Mészáros's autobiographical trilogy, starring Zsuzsa Czinkóczi. It won the Grand Prize at Cannes 1984. Hungary, 1984, drama.

MISTRZYNIE, MISTRZOWIE

Dziennik panny służącej

Diary of a Chambermaid

16:15–17:49 · KNH 9 · Radu Jude · Rumunia, Francja, 2026 · 94 min • Q&A after screening

Romanian director Radu Jude's dark comedy-satire updating Octave Mirbeau's "Diary of a Chambermaid," about a Romanian migrant maid in Paris who stages amateur theatrical versions of the novel for her wealthy employers.

Gianina, a Romanian migrant worker in contemporary Paris, works as a maid for a wealthy, pseudo-intellectual couple and by night performs amateur reenactments of Octave Mirbeau's classic novel for their entertainment, while staying in touch with her daughter who lives abroad. Director Radu Jude uses the century-old source material (previously filmed by Renoir and Buñuel) to build a satire of modern servitude and exploitation, described as darkly comic yet "surprisingly tender." Romania/France, 2026, 94 minutes.

ODKRYCIA

Dni, których nie znamy

Days Yet Unknown

16:15–17:36 · KNH 3 · Jola Wiecezorek · Austria, 2026 · 81 min • Q&A after screening

Austrian documentary in which director Jola Wiecezorek traces her family's late-1980s emigration from Poland to Austria through letters, home footage and archival material.

Using letters, personal recollections, archival footage and home movies, director Jola Wiecezorek (in her feature documentary debut) reconstructs her parents' emigration from a Poznań apartment to Austria in the late 1980s. The film widens from personal family history into a broader portrait of Eastern European families seeking opportunity in the West, gaining added weight during production when Wiecezorek's mother's health began declining. It won the Max Ophüls Prize for Best Documentary and a Local Artist Award at Crossing Europe 2026. Austria, 81 minutes.

ODKRYCIA

Modlitwa za umierających

A Prayer for the Dying

16:15–17:50 · DCF W-wa · Dara Van Dusen · Norwegia, Grecja, Wielka Brytania, Szwecja, 2026 · 95 min

Horror-tinged period drama set in a small Wisconsin town after the Civil War, where a sheriff-pastor fights a diphtheria outbreak that kills his own child.

Sheriff and pastor Jacob Hansen investigates a vagrant's death in the woods near his small post-Civil War Wisconsin town; a doctor rules it diphtheria, and the disease then spreads through the community, killing multiple residents including Hansen's own child. Adapted from Stewart O'Nan's 1999 novel, the film mixes horror, western and psychological drama, playing more like a grim morality tale than a conventional western. It is director Dara Van Dusen's feature debut. Norway/Greece/UK/Sweden co-production, 95 minutes.

FRONT WIZUALNY

Chronovisor

16:30–18:09 · DCF Polonia · Kevin Walker, Jack Auen · USA, 2026 · 99 min

Experimental sci-fi/essay film about a Columbia University researcher investigating the "chronovisor," a device a 1950s Vatican-linked monk allegedly built to view the past.

Dr. Béatrice Courte, a Columbia University researcher, investigates the legend of the "chronovisor," a device supposedly invented in the 1950s by Benedictine monk and physicist Pellegrino Ernetti to watch historical events unfold. Through archival research and interviews with people worldwide who may have knowledge of the device, the film blends real and speculative material, citing Borges and Eco as influences. Shot on 16mm, it premiered at Rotterdam 2026. USA, 99 minutes, experimental/speculative fiction.

Block 3 — Evening

18:45–19:15 starts · choose ONE film from this block

MIĘDZYNARODOWY KONKURS NOWE HORYZONTY

Dryfy

The Currents

18:45–20:29 · KNH 7 · Milagros Mumenthaler · Szwajcaria, Argentyna, 2025 · 104 min

Argentine psychological drama about a fashion designer who secretly survives jumping into an icy river, then unravels physically and mentally back home.

Lina, an aspiring fashion designer, impulsively jumps from a bridge into an icy river during a work trip abroad and survives. Back in Buenos Aires she tells no one, but develops a paralyzing fear of water and a growing sense that she never fully returned - alongside physical symptoms like a skin rash and lank hair. Shot with minimalist, film-noir-inspired visuals, it's a slow psychological unraveling rather than a plot-driven thriller. Won the RTVE-Otra Mirada Award at San Sebastian 2025; also played Toronto and New York.

POKAZY GALOWE

Ktoś we mnie

The Unknown

18:45–21:04 · KNH 1 · Arthur Harari · Francja, Włochy, 2026 · 139 min

French metaphysical thriller in which a woman's consciousness transfers into a man's body after they sleep together, unraveling both their identities.

Introverted photographer David meets a mysterious woman, Eva, at a party; after they have sex, Eva finds her mind has somehow moved into David's body. The two spiral into an increasingly surreal reality where memory, identity, and physical form no longer hold together. Based on the graphic novel 'The Case of David Zimmerman', with Lea Seydoux and Niels Schneider leading and director Radu Jude in a cameo. Won in the main competition at Cannes; contains strobe lighting effects.

TRZECIE OKO: KLUB ZŁAMANYCH SERC

Piękny i schludny pokój

Beautiful and Neat Room

18:45–20:43 · KNH 6 · Maria Petschnig · USA, Austria, 2025 · 118 min • Q&A after screening

American tragicomedy about a Brooklyn artist who rents out her spare room to a revolving cast of difficult roommates to afford the city.

Marie is an artist in a small, gentrifying Brooklyn apartment who takes in one roommate after another to make rent. Each new tenant, initially harmless-seeming, becomes a source of friction, forcing Marie to confront her own patience, anxieties, and ideas about self-sufficiency. It's a bittersweet comedy about housing precarity and forced intimacy with strangers, and the directorial debut of Maria Petschnig, who drew on her own experience of 60-plus roommates over two decades in New York. Contains trigger-warning content per the festival listing.

Nienormalni

The Abnormal

18:45–20:03 · KNH 4 · Jacek Bławut · Polska, 1990 · 78 min • Q&A after screening

1990 Polish semi-documentary following children with intellectual disabilities at a care facility as they take music lessons with a new instructor.

Set in a residential care center in Kozice Dolne, the film follows children participating in music classes with a new teacher, using a loosely scripted scenario while the participants' emotional reactions - joy, frustration, anger, sorrow - are genuine and unscripted. Directed by Jacek Bławut, it was considered groundbreaking for its time in how it portrayed intellectually disabled subjects as young people with their own desires rather than as objects of pity. Won the Journalists' Award at Gdynia 1990 and the FIPRESCI Prize at Mannheim-Heidelberg 1991. The festival notes the film may raise present-day concerns about privacy given its child subjects.

TROPIKALNY GOTYK

Śmierć nie ma pana

Death Has No Master

18:45–20:30 · DCF Lwów · Jorge Thielen Armand · Wenezuela, Włochy, Kanada, Luksemburg, Hiszpania, Meksyk, 2026 · 105 min

Venezuelan gothic thriller starring Asia Argento as a woman who returns after 20 years abroad to sell her family's decaying cocoa plantation, only to find it occupied by workers' families.

Caro comes back to Venezuela after two decades away to sell an inherited cocoa estate, but finds the crumbling property still inhabited by former plantation workers and their families, who depend on it for shelter. Her push to reclaim the land escalates into violent conflict over ownership, memory, and power, surfacing the estate's colonial history. The film blends psychological thriller with 'tropical gothic' and Italian giallo influences. Contains strobe lighting effects; director Jorge Thielen Armand is a 2021 Guggenheim Fellow.

FALE

Najsamotniejszy człowiek w mieście

The Loneliest Man in Town

19:00–20:26 · KNH 8 · Tizza Covi, Rainer Frimmel · Austria, 2026 · 86 min • Q&A after screening

Austrian semi-documentary about an aging Vienna blues musician who dreams of the Mississippi Delta while facing eviction from his soon-to-be-demolished building.

Alois Koch, who goes by 'Al Cook', is a melancholic blues musician living near the Danube in Vienna, a city he finds provincial compared to the Mississippi Delta blues scene he idolizes. As the last remaining resident of a building slated for demolition, he holds a yard sale of his possessions, which becomes an occasion to encounter Vienna's other eccentric characters. The film mixes documentary observation with staged elements and blends melancholy with dry humor. Directors Tizza Covi and Rainer Frimmel previously won awards including one for 'Vera' (Venice 2022).

ODKRYCIA

Biały ślimak

White Snail

19:00–20:55 · KNH 2 · Elsa Kremser, Levin Peter · Austria, Niemcy, 2025 · 115 min

Documentary-fiction hybrid set in Minsk about a model and a morgue restorer who play fictionalized versions of themselves as they form a cautious relationship amid Belarus's political unrest.

Masza, training at modeling school for an international career while hiding inner sadness, and Mikhail, who does restorative cosmetic work in a morgue and paints dark imagery in private, are real people playing themselves in this staged-documentary experiment. Their tentative connection develops through summer walks in Minsk as Belarus's political tensions rise in the background; only their meeting was arranged for the camera, marking both subjects' film debut. Winner of the Special Jury Prize and Best Performance at Locarno 2025, Best Film at Sarajevo 2025, and other awards. Content warnings noted by the festival.

ODKRYCIA

Clarissa

19:00–21:15 · DCF W-wa · Arie Esiri, Chuko Esiri · USA, Nigeria, 2026 · 135 min

Drama transposing Virginia Woolf's *Mrs Dalloway* to present-day Lagos, following one day in the life of an elite Nigerian woman preparing an evening party.

The film follows a single day in the life of a wealthy Lagos woman as she prepares to host a gathering, encountering people from her past and present who prompt reflection on her life choices, lost loves, and missed chances. A parallel storyline follows a soldier suffering PTSD from fighting Boko Haram, contrasting the protagonist's privileged world with Nigeria's harsher realities. Directed by Arie and Chuko Esiri (previously behind 'Eyimofe'), it stars Sophie Okonedo, Ayo Edebiri, and David Oyelowo, and premiered in the Quinzaine des cineastes at Cannes.

SMART 7

Gość

The Visitor

19:00–20:54 · DCF Lalka · Vytautas Katkus · Litwa, Norwegia, Szwecja, 2025 · 114 min

Lithuanian drama about a 30-year-old man who returns to his late father's seaside childhood home to sell it, and instead drifts into an unplanned vacation confronting grief and impending fatherhood.

Danielius comes back to his childhood home by the sea intending to sell it after his father's death, but his practical errand dissolves into an aimless stay in a place that's now familiar yet foreign to him. The film wanders through his grief, his anxiety about becoming a father himself, and nostalgia for a lost sense of security, as he says a quiet goodbye to his youth. Co-written by Maria Kavtaradze and edited by Laurynas Bareisa, it won Best Director in the main competition at Karlovy Vary 2025.

OSLO / REYKJAVIK

Arru

19:00–20:35 · KNH 5 · Elle Sofe Sara · Norwegia, Szwecja, Finlandia, 2026 · 95 min

Sami-language musical drama set in Norway's Sapmi region about siblings caught between fighting a mining company and confronting buried family trauma.

Siblings Maia and Danel face a crisis in their reindeer-herding community as mining interests threaten their land. Maia brings their uncle Lemme back from Canada, a man who once successfully halted a mining project on Sami territory, but his return dredges up old family trauma, worsening Danel's struggles with alcohol. Incorporating traditional joik singing and Sami spiritual ritual, the film weighs individual versus community and tradition versus industry against stunning Nordic landscapes. It's the debut feature by choreographer-filmmaker Elle Sofe Sara and premiered in Berlinale's Panorama section; contains content warnings.

POKAZY GALOWE

Powiedz mi, co czujesz

Tell Me What You Feel

19:15–20:59 · KNH 9 · Łukasz Ronduda · Polska, 2026 · 104 min · Q&A after screening

Polish drama about two young Warsaw artists from different class backgrounds falling into their first serious adult relationship, which reopens old emotional wounds.

Maria, from a wealthy Warsaw family, and Patryk, a struggling art student, fall into a relationship that becomes a mirror for their respective pasts and insecurities, complicated by their differing socioeconomic backgrounds. The film engages with Generation Z anxieties around intimacy and 'new masculinity' open to vulnerability, and the therapeutic role art can play in relationships. Directed by Łukasz Ronduda and inspired by real-life artists Patryk Rozycki and Karolina Balcer, plus the art project 'Skup lez'. Premiered in the Big Screen Competition at Rotterdam; contains content/trigger warnings.

FRONT WIZUALNY

Wolfgang

19:15–20:53 · KNH 3 · Filmsaaz · Iran, Francja, Szwajcaria, 2026 · 98 min · Q&A after screening

Experimental opera-film in which a depressed Paris-based rapper becomes convinced he is Mozart, intercut with the real Mozart's 1778 crisis in Paris.

A rapper in contemporary Paris, struggling with depression, aimlessness, substance use, and creative block, develops the delusion that he is Mozart, and the film draws parallels to Mozart's own breakdown in Paris in 1778 (when, aged 22, he lost his mother). Told through arias and dreamlike, surreal visuals blending video art and performance, it's described as simultaneously intimate and absurd. Directed by Iranian audiovisual artist Filmsaaz (b. 1999), whose work has shown at Cannes, Berlin, Venice, and Locarno. Contains strobing lights.

LOST LOST LOST

Jeśli się przewrócę, nie podnoś mnie

If I Fall, Don't Pick Me Up

19:15–21:20 · DCF Polonia · Declan Clarke · Irlandia, 2024 · 125 min

Irish experimental essay film reconstructing 1974 Berlin, where theatre director Walter Asmus helped Samuel Beckett stage his first self-directed 'Waiting for Godot'.

The film documents Berlin in 1974 through the real relationship between Walter Asmus and playwright Samuel Beckett, who worked together on Beckett's first self-directed production of 'Waiting for Godot' and became lifelong friends. Director Declan Clarke interweaves footage of Berlin locations Beckett frequented with archival and textual material, using the city's empty, modernist spaces as an emotional guide to the story. It's a slow, museum-essay-film style work rather than a conventional narrative. Won a Special Recognition in the international competition at FIDMarseille 2024. Screens paired with the short 'Gdzie się podzieli wszyscy moi kochankowie?' (Jean-Claude Rousseau, 2024).

Block 4 — Night

21:30–22:30 starts · choose ONE film from this block

OSLO / REYKJAVIK

Wartość sentymentalna

Sentimental Value

21:30–23:43 · Rynek · Joachim Trier · Norwegia, Niemcy, Dania, Francja, Szwecja, Wielka Brytania, Turcja, 2025 · 133 min

Norwegian drama about two sisters reuniting with their estranged filmmaker father, who casts a Hollywood star instead of one of them in his comeback film.

Sisters Nora and Agnes reconnect with their estranged father Gustav, a once-celebrated film director attempting a comeback after years away. When Gustav offers the lead role in his new film to Nora and she turns it down, he instead casts American star Elle Fanning, upending the family's fragile dynamics. Directed by Joachim Trier (*The Worst Person in the World*), starring Renate Reinsve and Stellan Skarsgård. Won the Grand Prix at Cannes 2025 and Best International Feature at the 2026 Oscars and BAFTA. A family drama about art, ambition, and reconciliation.

OPT ZAMEK W LEŚNICY

Nad rzeką, której nie ma

By the River That Isn't There

21:30–22:55 · Zamek · Andrzej Barański · Polska, 1991 · 85 min

1991 Polish coming-of-age drama about four teenage boys in a small provincial town whose friendship is tested when a girl moves in one summer.

Set in a small Polish town in the 1960s, the film follows four teenage boys nicknamed Admirał, Ataman, Wódz and Pasza as they drink cheap wine and kill time over a boring summer. Their group dynamic shifts when an attractive newcomer, Marta, arrives, introducing them to romantic rivalry and heartbreak. Adapted from a short story by Stanisław Czycz and directed by Andrzej Barański, who called it a personal, nostalgic look back at his own youth. Screens as part of the festival's outdoor programme at Zamek w Leśnicy.

MIĘDZYNARODOWY KONKURS NOWE HORYZONTY

The Meltdown

21:45–23:33 · KNH 7 · Manuela Martelli · Chile, USA, Hiszpania, Meksyk, 2026 · 108 min

Chilean mystery/coming-of-age drama set in 1992, where a nine-year-old girl at her grandparents' Andes ski hotel befriends a young athlete who then vanishes.

Chile, 1992: nine-year-old Inés spends her holidays at her grandparents' hotel near a ski resort in the Andes, where she befriends Hanna, a German skier training with the Olympic team under a demanding coach. When Hanna mysteriously disappears, Inés's fascination turns into unease as the search uncovers secrets hidden within the hotel and within a country still grappling with its dictatorial past. Directed by Manuela Martelli (Chile '76), pairing a child's-eye mystery with a meditation on Chile's suppressed historical memory. Slow-paced, understated tone; screening in the festival's International Competition.

POKAZY GALOWE

Czarna kula

The Black Ball

21:45-00:20 · KNH 1 · Javier Calvo, Javier Ambrossi · Hiszpania, Francja, 2026 · 155 min

Spanish drama spanning 1932, 1937 and 2017 that traces three gay men's lives across generations, built around an unfinished text by Federico García Lorca.

Directors Javier Calvo and Javier Ambrossi (*Skins*, *Smiley*, *The Prince*) weave historical fact and myth around poet Federico García Lorca into a story about three men across three time periods: 1932, 1937 and 2017. It centers on a wealthy, closeted man seeking membership in a casino who is rejected by a homophobic committee via secret ballot -- white balls mean acceptance, black balls mean rejection, giving the film its title. The film explores desire, repression, shame and Catholic guilt, framed as connecting generations of gay men whose stories were erased by violence or silence. Runtime 155 minutes, Spain/France 2026, screening as a Gala show.

MISTRZYNIE, MISTRZOWIE

Krwawa Hrabina

The Blood Countess

21:45-23:44 · KNH 4 · Ulrike Ottinger · Austria, Luksemburg, Niemcy, 2026 · 119 min

Vampire comedy where Isabelle Huppert plays a resurrected Elizabeth Báthory stalking modern Vienna in latex and glitter with her maid, hunting a life-giving elixir.

Loosely based on the legend of 16th-century Hungarian countess and alleged serial killer Elizabeth Báthory, the film follows the resurrected countess (Isabelle Huppert) and her maid (Birgit Minichmayr) through contemporary Vienna as they search for a "red elixir of life" and a hidden family history tied to a book that could end their vampire lineage. Directed by veteran experimental filmmaker Ulrike Ottinger, co-written with Nobel laureate Elfriede Jelinek (*The Piano Teacher*). Campy, deliberately artificial tone mixing dark humor, kitsch and Austro-Hungarian mythology, with bumbling vampire hunters (including performer Conchita Wurst) in pursuit. Premiered at Berlinale 2026; part of the festival's "Mistrzynie, Mistrzowie" retrospective sidebar.

GARDEN PARTY

Ogród

The Garden

21:45-23:29 · DCF Lwów · Derek Jarman · Wielka Brytania, Niemcy, Japonia, 1990 · 104 min

Derek Jarman's 1990 experimental film-diary shot around his cottage garden on the English coast, made after his HIV diagnosis, with no conventional plot.

A deeply personal, non-narrative work by British director Derek Jarman, made at Prospect Cottage on the Dungeness coast -- the garden he cultivated after being diagnosed with HIV. Rather than tell a story, the film assembles a kaleidoscope of surreal 16mm/35mm images -- wind-blown flowers, grass, waves and clotheslines -- interwoven with diary-like reflections later published as the book *Modern Nature*. It functions as a meditation on mortality and a critique of conservative Britain in the late 1980s/early 90s, with the garden as a symbol of paradise and refuge. Won an award at Berlinale 1991. Screens paired with the short "Piękne kwiaty i ich hodowla" (Beautiful Flowers and How to Grow Them) by Sarah Wood, as part of the "Garden Party" strand.

NOCNE SZALEŃSTWO

Lewitując

Levitating

22:00–23:59 · KNH 8 · Wregas Bhanuteja · Indonezja, Singapur, Filipiny, Francja, Tajwan, Tajlandia, Korea Południowa, 2026 · 119 min

Indonesian drama about a young man training to become a shaman who leads trance-possession parties, trying to raise money to stop his family losing their home.

In an Indonesian town where communal ecstasy comes through spirit possession, Bayu aspires to become the shaman of a trance party -- inducing collective trance through music and ritual -- to raise money and prevent his family's eviction, while his father plans to sell their home and move to the capital. Along the way he is helped by, and drawn closer to, Laksmi and the singer Asri. Directed by Wregas Bhanuteja, the film blends real and invented Indonesian ritual and dance traditions with themes of community, tradition versus capitalist pressure, and self-discovery. Premiered at Sundance 2026; screens in the festival's late-night "Nocne Szaleństwo" strand.

LOST LOST LOST

Noc się dłuży

The Night Drags On

22:00–23:35 · KNH 5 · Mathilde Girard · Francja, 2023 · 95 min

An experimental essay film shot in Paris's Belleville, Ménilmontant and La Roquette neighborhoods during the COVID-19 pandemic, observing everyday life among African and Middle Eastern diaspora communities through taxi rides, street scenes, and a young woman alone in her apartment.

Site-specific poetic essay film built from three overlapping visual threads: conversations recorded in taxis, footage of street traffic, and scenes of a young woman alone in a small Paris apartment. Shot during COVID-19 lockdown in multicultural eastern Paris districts rarely seen by tourists. Built from repetition, chance encounters and daily routines rather than plot, evoking Marguerite Duras and Chantal Akerman. Won an award at FIDMarseille. Screens paired with the short film 'Miłość na ścieżce jeżyn' (Love on the Bramble Path, dir. Sophie Roger, France, 2025, 24 min).

GARDEN PARTY

Filipiñana

22:00–23:43 · KNH 2 · Rafael Manuel · Singapur, Wielka Brytania, Filipiny, Francja, Holandia, 2026 · 103 min

A drama set at a luxury tropical resort in the Philippines that follows the invisible service staff who maintain the illusion of paradise for wealthy guests.

Set inside a manicured luxury resort, the film examines the hidden labor - housekeeping, groundskeeping, service with a smile - that sustains an image of paradise for guests. Rather than overt conflict, tension builds through small cracks in the performance: a smile held too long, a worker briefly breaking character. Director Rafael Manuel favors quiet observation and social critique over spectacle, using the resort as a metaphor for class and labor inequality. Screens paired with the short film 'She Dolls with Dolly' (dir. Karin Fisslthaler, Austria, 2024, 3 min).

TROPIKALNY GOTYK

Czysta krew

Pure Blood

22:00–23:39 · DCF Lalka · Luis Ospina · Kolumbia, 1982 · 99 min

A 1982 Colombian horror-satire in which a wealthy, terminally ill plantation owner is kept alive by regular blood transfusions while young men mysteriously vanish from the city.

A rich, dying sugar-plantation patriarch depends on constant blood transfusions to survive; his family's aides resort to abducting and killing young people to supply blood, while the city panics over disappearances blamed on 'the Monster of Mangones.' Loosely based on real events - the murder of dozens of street children in Cali, Colombia, in the 1960s-70s. Director Luis Ospina mixes vampire-horror tropes with black comedy and crime-thriller elements to satirize class privilege and elite indifference. A key work of Colombian 'tropical gothic' cinema, screening in the festival's Tropikalny Gotyk section.

SEZON

Romería

22:00–23:51 · DCF Polonia · Carla Simón · Hiszpania, 2025 · 111 min

A drama in which 17-year-old Marina travels to Vigo, Spain to obtain paperwork needed for a university scholarship, and in doing so uncovers a long-hidden family secret.

Marina returns to her father's hometown of Vigo to get a document required for a scholarship application, and the visit forces her extended family to confront a secret they've suppressed for years. Director Carla Simón (Alcarràs) blends present-day scenes with home-movie/archival-style footage to explore family memory, shame, and denial. The story doubles as a tribute to relatives lost to the AIDS epidemic whose deaths were erased or hidden within family history. A personal, semi-autobiographical drama about uncovering one's roots.

NOCNE SZALEŃSTWO

Gorgona

22:15–23:50 · KNH 6 · Evi Kalogiropoulou · Grecja, Francja, 2025 · 95 min

A post-apocalyptic genre film set in a fuel-refinery city-state ruled by a cult of macho masculinity, where women are traded for gasoline until a female uprising challenges the male leader's chosen successor.

In a post-apocalyptic city built around a giant refinery, men trade fuel for women and food while worshipping their leader, Nikos. Maria, a tough woman positioned to become his successor, has her plans upended when the mysterious, liberated Eleni arrives and pushes her toward rebellion. The film mixes kitsch aesthetics, neon-lit cinematography and classical/mythic references to stage a clash between toxic masculinity and a militant, queer-inflected matriarchy. A genre mashup of sci-fi, feminist allegory, and erotic thriller.

TROPIKALNY GOTYK

Jaripeo

22:15–23:25 · KNH 3 · Rebecca Zweig, Efraín Mojica · Meksyk, USA, Francja, 2026 · 70 min

A documentary about jaripeo (Mexican bull-riding rodeo culture) that follows Noé, a traditional cowboy, and Joseph, a gender-nonconforming participant, inside this hypermasculine world.

Documentary look at jaripeo, the Mexican bull-riding tradition rooted in cattle-ranching culture, the regional counterpart to the American rodeo. It centers on two figures within the scene: Noé, a conventional cowboy, and Joseph, who doesn't fit the binary gender norms typical of the milieu, as both navigate attraction, family pressures, and self-discovery. Shot on Super 8 combined with music-video-style visuals, mixing communal rodeo scenes with intimate personal conversation. Explores queerness and identity inside a traditionally hypermasculine subculture.

SEZON

Sirât

22:15–00:09 · DCF W-wa · Oliver Laxe · Hiszpania, Francja, 2025 · 114 min

A survival-thriller drama in which a father (Sergi López), accompanied by his young son, searches for his missing daughter through illegal desert rave parties in Morocco.

A father scours illegal, off-grid rave parties in the Moroccan desert looking for his missing daughter. After days of searching he falls in with a group of itinerant ravers and travels with them toward the Mauritanian border, where the journey turns dangerous and events spiral out of control. Won the Jury Prize at the 2025 Cannes Film Festival. Combines road-movie and survival-thriller elements against a backdrop of rave culture and social/political breakdown; described as an increasingly intense, unpredictable ride.

NOCNE SZALEŃSTWO

Leviticus

22:30–23:58 · KNH 9 · Adrian Chiarella · Australia, 2026 · 88 min

A drama about two teenage boys, Naim and Ryan, whose intense romantic relationship in a religious, industrial-town setting turns fatal after they are subjected to conversion therapy.

Naim, a new student, moves with his religiously fundamentalist mother to an industrial town, where he becomes involved with Ryan, a rougher classmate. Their immediate, intense connection develops into a relationship their community rejects, and the boys are subjected to conversion therapy with fatal consequences. The title references the Book of Leviticus, a biblical text some interpret as condemning homosexuality. Framed as a cautionary tale about religious extremism and attempts to suppress identity through faith-based 'conversion' practices.
